

UChicago REU Notes Week 1

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1 Week 1

Here it's mainly the preparation for any further theory in spectra. To learn the material, here I focused mainly on some topological preliminaries. Main reference comes from *Concise Course in Algebraic Topology*.

Remark 1.1. I believe most texts assume that compactness means not only the existence of finite subcover for arbitrary open cover, but also Hausdorffness on the space. Here, we also assume this.

1.1 Compactly Generated Spaces

In most literatures I've read, the spaces are assumed to be compactly generated. So, this section is collecting some information I have about it. First, starting with the notion of k -spaces:

Definition 1.2. Given a topological space X , a subset $A \subseteq X$ is k -closed, if for any compact space K , and continuous map $g : K \rightarrow X$, the preimage $g^{-1}(A) \subseteq K$ is closed.

X is a k -space, if any k -closed subset $A \subseteq X$ is closed.

Which, adapting the usual continuous maps, this realizes a *Category of k -spaces*, denoting $k\mathcal{U}$. There are some properties about this category, regarding a functor from regular category of spaces $\mathcal{U}$, and this category's completeness / cocompleteness.

Definition 1.3. Given a space X , define a topological space kX where the underlying set coincides with X , while requiring all k -closed sets $A \subseteq X$ to be closed in kX as its new topology.

This construction satisfies the closed sets axioms, hence form a topology; also, under the new topology, kX is a k -space. Furthermore, since all closed sets are automatically k -closed, the set identity function $\iota_X : kX \rightarrow X$ is in fact continuous.

We want to further argue k is a functor $\mathcal{U} \rightarrow k\mathcal{U}$, which can be achieved with the following proposition:

Proposition 1.4. *Let Z be a k -space, Y arbitrary topological space, and $f : Z \rightarrow Y$ a continuous map. Then, there exists a unique continuous map $kf : Z \rightarrow kY$, such that the following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Z & \xrightarrow{\forall f} & Y \\ & \searrow \exists! kf & \nearrow \iota_Y \\ & kY & \end{array}$$

Proof. Since ι_Y is a set identity map, uniqueness of kf is clear (as set function it coincides with f). To show kf is continuous, it suffices to show all k -closed set $A \subseteq Y$ has preimage $f^{-1}(A) \subseteq Z$ being closed.

Let $g : K \rightarrow Z$ be arbitrary continuous map, with K being compact. Consider $f \circ g : K \rightarrow Z \rightarrow Y$, for any $A \subseteq Y$ that's k -closed, $(f \circ g)^{-1}(A) = g^{-1}(f^{-1}(A)) \subseteq K$ is closed, hence $f^{-1}(A) \subseteq Z$ is also k -closed. Since Z is a k -space, $f^{-1}(A)$ is closed. $\square$

Corollary 1.5. *Given any continuous map $f : X \rightarrow Y$, there exists a unique continuous map $kf : kX \rightarrow kY$, such that the following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X & \xrightarrow{\forall f} & Y \\ \iota_X \uparrow & & \uparrow \iota_Y \\ kX & \xrightarrow{\exists! kf} & kY \end{array}$$

Proof. Since $f \circ \iota_X : kX \rightarrow Y$ is continuous, with kX being a k -space, **Proposition 1.4** guarantees the existence and uniqueness of kf (which as set map it also agrees with f , as ι_X is set identity). $\square$

This formulates $k : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow k\mathcal{U}$ as a functor. And, if consider the inclusion functor $\mathcal{I} : k\mathcal{U} \rightarrow \mathcal{U}$, **Proposition 1.4** also insists $(\mathcal{I}, k)$ as an adjoint pair, as it phrases a natural isomorphism as follow:

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{U}}(\mathcal{I}Z, Y) \cong \text{Hom}_{k\mathcal{U}}(Z, kY), \quad f \mapsto kf$$

Using some categorical nonsense, k as a right adjoint preserves all limits, so $k\mathcal{U}$ is a complete category. In particular, we denote $X \times^k Y := k(X \times Y)$ as the product of two k -spaces X, Y .

To show it's also cocomplete, consider the following:

Proposition 1.6. *Quotient of a k -space is still a k -space; arbitrary disjoint union of k -spaces is a k -space.*

Proof. Let X be a k -space, and $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a quotient map. For any k -closed subset $A \subseteq Y$, consider arbitrary continuous map $g : K \rightarrow X$ with K compact. Given the composition $f \circ g : K \rightarrow X \rightarrow Y$, $(f \circ g)^{-1}(A) = g^{-1}(f^{-1}(A)) \subseteq K$ is closed, hence $f^{-1}(A) \subseteq X$ is k -closed, which is closed as X is a k -space. Then, using the quotient space property, $A = f(f^{-1}(A)) \subseteq Y$ is closed, concluding that Y is also a k -space.

Now, given $\{X_i\}_i$ a family of k -spaces, consider $Z := \coprod_i X_i$, with $\iota_i : X_i \rightarrow Z$ the canonical inclusion. Given any k -closed subset $A \subseteq Z$, similar logic from previous proofs show that $A \cap X_i = \iota_i^{-1}(A) \subseteq X_i$ are all k -closed, hence closed (as X_i 's are k -spaces). Which, this verifies $A \subseteq Z$ is closed under the disjoint union topology, showing Z is also a k -space. $\square$

This guarantees the coproduct and coequalizers of k -spaces (and maps between them) in $\mathcal{U}$ are still k -spaces, which these colimits exist in $k\mathcal{U}$, showing the cocompleteness.

Now, move on to another criterion for compactly generated spaces:

Definition 1.7. A space X is k -Hausdorff if the diagonal $\Delta X \subset k(X \times X)$ is closed.

Denote $h\mathcal{U}$ as the *Category of k -Hausdorff spaces*.

There's a lot more details for this, I'll try and fill it in afterward==.

There is another functor $h : \mathcal{U} \rightarrow h\mathcal{U}$ which generates a k -Hausdorff space out of any topological spaces, and with inclusion functor $\mathcal{J} : h\mathcal{U} \rightarrow \mathcal{U}$, they form an adjoint pair $(h, \mathcal{J})$. So, h as a left adjoint preserves colimits.

Finally, for compactly generated spaces, it's defined as a k -Hausdorff k -space. In this space, limits and colimits exist, but need to be constructed in $\mathcal{U}$, then apply the functor h or k to yield the desired results.

Another equivalent way to phrase k -Hausdorffness when given a k -space, is the *weak Hausdorffness*: Given any continuous map $g : K \rightarrow X$ with K compact, $g(K) \subseteq X$ is a closed subset.

1.2 Spaces of Maps

This section, we'd like to realize $Y^X := \text{Hom}_{\text{Top}}(X, Y)$ (the set of all continuous maps $X \rightarrow Y$) as a topological space. Here, we consider the *compact open topology*.

First, given the any map $f : K \times X \rightarrow Y$, there is a corresponding set function $\tilde{f} : K \rightarrow Y^X$ by $\tilde{f}(k) = f(k, _) : X \rightarrow Y$.

Definition 1.8. The *compact open topology* on $\text{Hom}_{\text{Top}}(X, Y)$, has $S \subseteq Y^X$ being open iff all compact space K , continuous map $f : K \times X \rightarrow Y$, the set

$$\tilde{f}^{-1}(S) = \{k \in K | f(k, _) \in S\}$$

is open in K .

Obviously, $\emptyset, Y^X$ are both open; if $\{S_i \subseteq Y^X\}_i$ are open, then $\tilde{f}^{-1}(\bigcup_i S_i) = \bigcup_i \tilde{f}^{-1}(S_i)$ is open in K , so $\bigcup_i S_i$ is open; finally, if $S, S' \subseteq Y^X$ are open, then $\tilde{f}^{-1}(S \cap S') = \tilde{f}^{-1}(S) \cap \tilde{f}^{-1}(S')$ is open in K , so $S \cap S'$ is also open. This defines a topology.

Here is some nice properties of composition of maps:

Proposition 1.9. Given $g : X' \rightarrow X$, the precomposition $g^* := _ \circ g : Y^X \rightarrow Y^{X'}$ is continuous. Dually, given $h : Y \rightarrow Y'$, the postcomposition $h_* := h \circ _ : Y^X \rightarrow Y'^X$ is continuous.

Proof. In the first scenario, given arbitrary open subset $S' \subseteq Y^{X'}$, the preimage $S := (g^*)^{-1}(S') = \{\ell \in Y^X | \ell \circ g \in S'\}$. Fix arbitrary continuous map $f : K \times X \rightarrow Y$ with K compact, consider $\tilde{f}^{-1}(S) \subseteq K$, we get:

$$\tilde{f}^{-1}(S) = \{k \in K | f(k, _) \in S\} = \{k \in K | f(k, _) \circ g \in S'\}$$

Similarly, consider $f' := f \circ (\text{id}_K \times g) : K \times X' \rightarrow Y$ (by $f'(k, x') = f(k, g(x'))$), the set $\tilde{f}'^{-1}(S') \subseteq K$ is open by assumption, which it has the following description:

$$\tilde{f}'^{-1}(S') = \{k \in K | f'(k, _) \in S'\} = \{k \in K | f(k, _) \circ g \in S'\} = \tilde{f}^{-1}(S)$$

This shows the openness of $S \subseteq Y^X$.

For the second scenario, given arbitrary open subset $S' \subseteq Y'^X$, the preimage $S := h_*^{-1}(S') = \{\ell \in Y^X | h \circ \ell \in S'\}$. Fix arbitrary continuous map $f : K \times X \rightarrow Y$ with K compact, notice the following description:

$$\tilde{f}^{-1}(S) = \{k \in K | f(k, -) \in S\} = \{k \in K | h \circ f(k, -) \in S'\}$$

Which, notice $h \circ f : K \times X \rightarrow Y \rightarrow Y'$ satisfies $(h \circ f)^{-1}(S') = \{k \in K | h \circ f(k, -) \in S'\} = \tilde{f}^{-1}(S)$, and by assumption this set is open. So, $S \subseteq Y^X$ is open, finishing the claim. $\square$

As a result, the Hom functor $\text{Hom}_{\text{Top}} : \text{Top}^{\text{op}} \times \text{Top} \rightarrow \text{Top}$ is a bifunctor.

If restrict to the compactly generated spaces, there is a homeomorphism

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Top}}(X \times^k Y, Z) \cong \text{Hom}_{\text{Top}}(X, \text{Hom}_{\text{Top}}(Y, Z))$$

Yeah, more detailes to fill in.

1.3 Cofibration

Intuitively, these are the maps where homotopy can be extended to the codomain:

Definition 1.10. A map $\iota : A \rightarrow X$ is a *cofibration*, if it satisfies the *Homotopy Extension Property* (HEP). This means, given any map $f : X \rightarrow Y$, homotopy $H : A \times I \rightarrow Y$, zeroth inclusions $i_0 : A \rightarrow A \times I$ and $i_0 : X \rightarrow X \times I$ (by $x \mapsto (x, 0)$), and product map $\iota \times \text{id}_I : A \times I \rightarrow X \times I$, the homotopy extends to $\tilde{H} : X \times I \rightarrow Y$, with the following commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{i_0} & A \times I \\ \downarrow \iota & \nearrow H & \downarrow \iota \times \text{id}_I \\ & Y & \\ \uparrow f & \nwarrow \exists \tilde{H} & \\ X & \xrightarrow{i_0} & X \times I \end{array}$$

Intuitively, it gives a description of how to map X into Y (also how to map A into Y), generates a homotopy H on A only, and the property guarantees it to extend to a homotopy on X .

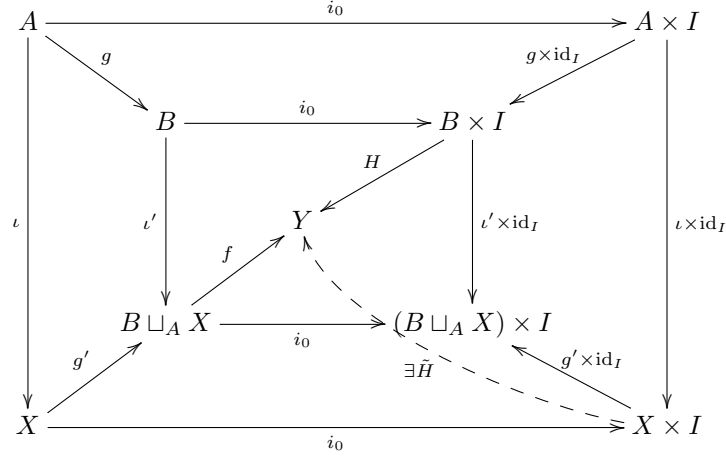
It's preserved under fibre product:

Lemma 1.11. If $\iota : A \rightarrow X$ is a cofibration, $g : A \rightarrow B$ any map, then the induced pushout $\iota' : B \rightarrow B \sqcup_A X$ is a cofibration:

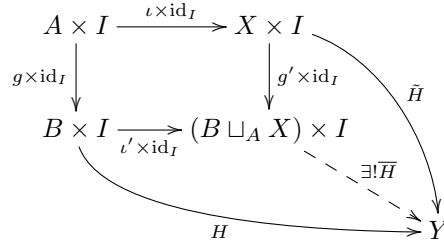
$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{\iota} & X \\ g \downarrow & & \downarrow g' \\ B & \xrightarrow{\iota'} & B \sqcup_A X \end{array}$$

Proof. Before starting, notice that product preserves adjunction/fibre coproduct, because $(B \sqcup_A X) \times I \cong (B \times I) \sqcup_{(A \times I)} (X \times I)$ (i.e. the first space can be viewed as the disjoint union of the product, then glue using identical methods at each $t \in I$).

Then, given map $f : B \sqcup_A X \rightarrow Y$, homotopy $H : B \times I$, and the fibre coproduct maps, we get:

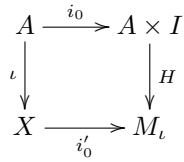


The existence of $\tilde{H}$ is given by HEP of $\iota : A \rightarrow X$. This induces the following diagram:

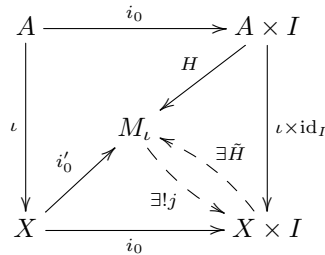


where $\overline{H}$ is induced by the fibre coproduct property. Plugin to the previous diagram, we yield the desired homotopy extension for the inner square. $\square$

If consider the “special case” $Y = M_\iota$, the mapping cylinder of $\iota : A \rightarrow X$ (which is constructed as $M_\iota := (A \times I \sqcup X) / \sim$, where $(a, 0) \sim f(a)$). Notice it generates the following fibre coproduct diagram:



So, the HEP and fibre coproduct property guarantees the following diagram:



Here, $\tilde{H}$ is the homotopy extension, j is the factorization by fibre coproduct. And, this enforces $\tilde{H} \circ j = \text{id}_{M_\iota}$, showing j is injective. If restrict to $t = 1$, then $j : A \times \{1\} \rightarrow X \times \{1\}$ is precisely the map ι , showing it's injective (in fact it's an embedding, because we also have a retract $\tilde{H} : X \times \{1\} \rightarrow A \times \{1\}$).

From other sources I can find, ι unfortunately doesn't have closed image in general, yet for the case of A, X being compactly generated (for instance, CW Complexes) I believe this is true. (Maybe by k -closed property).

So, we see $\iota : A \rightarrow X$ is a cofibration (for compactly generated spaces) directly implies ι is an embedding with closed image (or A is a closed subspace of X); and, the mapping cylinder is precisely $M_\iota = X \times \{0\} \cup A \times I$ in $X \times I$, the extended homotopy guarantees it's a retract of $X \times I$.

Conversely, given $A \subseteq X$ a closed subspace, while its mapping cylinder $M_\iota \subseteq X \times I$ is a retract of $X \times I$. Then, use the retract as the extended homotopy (together with the fact that it's a fibre coproduct, hence the "initial extension diagram" whenever seeking the homotopy extension for other Y), we get $A \hookrightarrow X$ is a cofibration.

So, for compactly generated spaces, it's equivalent to say: a cofibration is a closed embedding $A \subseteq X$, such that the mapping cylinder $X \times \{0\} \cup A \times I$ is a retract of $X \times I$.

To talk about homotopy equivalences of cofibers (which are not necessarily cofibrations, but just maps $A \rightarrow X$ when fixing A). Given, $i : A \rightarrow X, j : A \rightarrow Y$ two cofibers, a map $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a morphism, if the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & A & \\ i \swarrow & & \searrow j \\ X & \xrightarrow{f} & Y \end{array}$$

Definition 1.12. Two such morphisms $f, f' : X \rightarrow Y$ are homotopic in this category (under A), if they're homotopic relative to A , i.e. there exists homotopy $H : X \times I \rightarrow Y$ of f, f' , where all $a \in A, t \in I$ satisfies $H(i(a), t) = j(a)$ (namely A is fixed under this homotopy). This is called *cofiber homotopy*.

The homotopy equivalence built on cofiber homotopies is called *cofiber homotopy equivalence*.

This notion of homotopy equivalence is much stronger than original homotopy. Yet, when restricting to cofibrations, then it doesn't make a difference:

Proposition 1.13. *Given $i : A \rightarrow X, j : A \rightarrow Y$ two cofibrations, if morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a homotopy equivalence, then it's a cofiber homotopy equivalence.*

Proof. It suffices to find $g : Y \rightarrow X$ that's a homotopy invese, with $g \circ f \simeq \text{id}_X$ relative to A (because then apply the same argument on $g : Y \rightarrow X$, there is a homotopy inverse $f' : X \rightarrow Y$, such that $f' \circ g \simeq \text{id}_Y$ relative to A . As a result, $f = \text{id}_Y \circ f \simeq f' \circ g \circ f \simeq f' \circ \text{id}_X = f'$ relative to A , hence $f \circ g \simeq f' \circ g \simeq \text{id}_Y$ relative to A , showing it's a cofiber homotopy equivalence). $\square$

1.4

Definition 1.14. Given a based topological space X , its *reduced/based suspension* $\Sigma X := X \times I / X \vee I$, where $X \vee I$ is the wedge sum of X and interval I once fixed a basepoint $x_0 \in X$ and $i \in I$, while $X \times I$ has basepoint $(x_0, i) \in X \times I$.

Equivalently, $\Sigma X \cong X \wedge S^1 := X \times S^1 / X \vee S^1$.